

PSYCHIATRY

Abstract & Creative Thinking

Easy ways to find the meaning and find more ideas

WHAT IS IT?

EXERCISES

HOW TO CHECK

From “What is it?” to “What does it mean?”

Educational presentation — not a diagnostic test



START HERE

Two ways of thinking

One finds the meaning. One finds more ideas.



ABSTRACT THINKING

Find the hidden meaning

Ask: "What does it really mean?"



Example: "Don't cry over spilled milk"

→ Don't stay sad about small things that already happened.



CREATIVE THINKING

Find many different ideas

Ask: "What else is possible?"



Example: What can a spoon do?

→ Eat soup, stir tea, dig soil, play a drum!

KEY IDEA Abstract = find the meaning. Creative = find more ideas.

QUESTION 1

How can I improve abstract thinking?

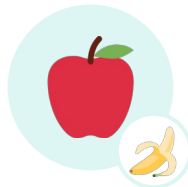
Look at something simple. Then find the bigger idea behind it.



1. What does it mean?

Try: “Slow and steady wins the race.”

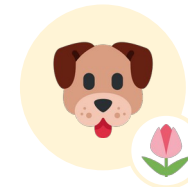
✓ Keep trying, step by step.



2. How are they the same?

Try: An apple and a banana?

✓ Both are fruits.



3. Make groups

Try: Dog, rose, cat, tulip

✓ Animals: dog, cat · Flowers: rose, tulip



4. Why? / What if?

Try: Why do we use umbrellas?

✓ To stay dry. No umbrella = wet!



5. Explain without the word

Try: Describe “apple” without saying it.

✓ A red, round fruit that grows on trees.



6. Say it in one line

Try: Read a short story.

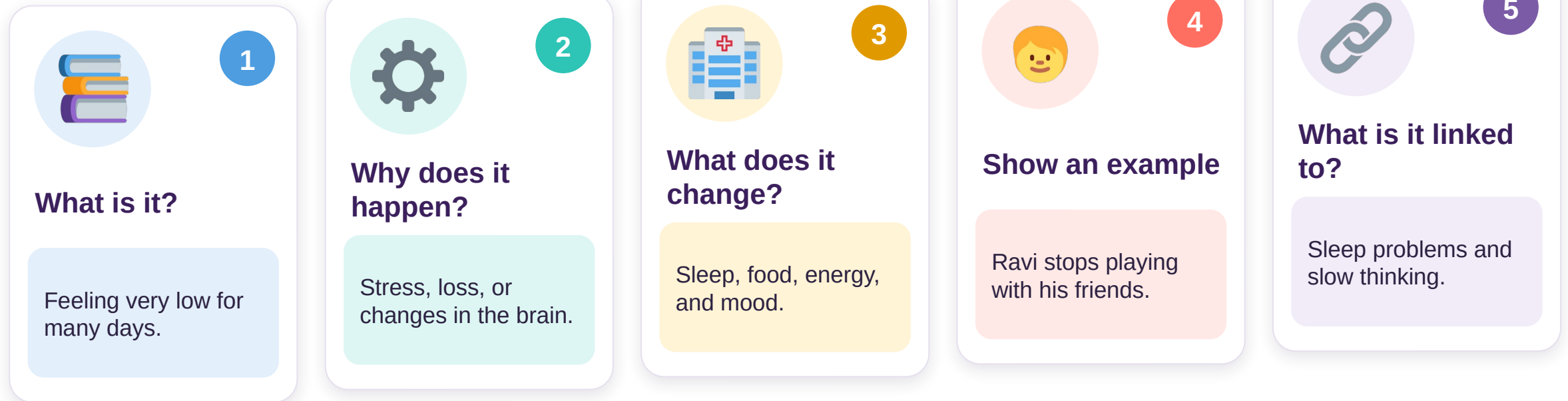
✓ Tell the main idea in one sentence.



Every day, 10 minutes: one thing, one meaning, one new link.

Learn one idea every day

Climb 5 easy steps. Today's example idea: feeling sad.



Tip: practise the thinking, not the words. Tomorrow try a new idea, like “worry” or “sleep”.

QUESTION 2

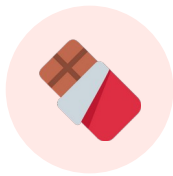
How can I improve creative thinking?

Find more than one idea first. Decide which is best later.



Many uses

Spoon: eat, stir, dig, drum... find 10!



What if?

What if it rained chocolate?



1 problem, 3 answers

No pen? Borrow one, use a pencil, or a phone.



Mix two things

Phone + notebook = a notebook that talks!



3 different endings

A dog runs away... make 3 happy endings.



5-minute ideas

Rainy-day fun: say as many ideas as you can.

EASY RULE



Think of ideas



Look closer



Mix them



Make it better



Class game: how many uses for a paper clip in 60 seconds?

QUESTION 3

As a doctor, how can I check these skills?

Use simple questions during the mental health check-up (MSE).



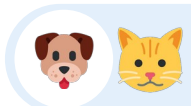
There is no single “right” answer. Look for meaning and for many ideas.



Abstract thinking test



Ask what a proverb means



Ask how two things are the same



Creative thinking test



Ask for many uses of a paper clip



Ask: “Any other idea?”

Be fair — think about:



School



Language



Culture



Attention



Mood



Other checks

Checking abstract thinking

Short, natural questions. Does the patient go past the literal words?



Doctor

“What does ‘Don’t judge a book by its cover’ mean?”

Patient

“Don’t judge a person only by how they look.”



Doctor

“How are a dog and a cat the same?”

Patient

“Both are animals and can be pets.”



RESULT

Good! Abstract thinking is working

The patient finds the hidden meaning and the bigger group (animals), not just small details.

Checking creative thinking

Look for many ideas and the ability to find new ones.



Doctor

"Imagine I give you a paper clip. Tell me as many uses as you can."

Patient

"To hold papers, as a bookmark, to tidy wires, or for crafts."



Doctor

"Can you think of another unusual use?"

Patient

"I could use it as a zipper pull!"



RESULT

Good! Many different ideas

- ✓ More than one idea
- ✓ Can add new ideas
- ✓ Clever answers not needed

4 easy steps to remember

Use them for study and with patients. Example: it is raining.



1. SEE

What do I see?

It is raining.



2. MEANING

What does it mean?

I will get wet outside.



3. MORE IDEAS

What else can I do?

Umbrella, raincoat, or wait.



4. USE IT

What will I do now?

Take the umbrella!



One answer is not a diagnosis. Also think about school, culture, language, attention, and mood.

Main message: see → find the meaning → find more ideas → use it.

PSYCHIATRY

Thank You!

Any questions?

Find the meaning

Find more ideas

Practise daily

